

Activity Report

Orientation to Retrofitting Beneficiaries about Retrofitting Measures Bhaktapur Municipality, Bhaktapur district

DATE: 13 November 2019

Activity Date and Venue:	13 November 2019/ Bhaktapur Municipality
Participants	- Bibek Gautam, M & E Specialist, DLPIU GMALI Bhaktapur - Prabesh Adhikari, DSE, DLPIU Building Bhaktapur - Shiva Prasad Bhandari, DSE, DLPIU Building Bhaktapur - Reeja Hathechu, Rabina, Samjhana Shrestha, Deepa Shrestha plus 2 more (Engineers of Bhaktapur Municipality) - Ashmita Shrestha, Engineer, DLPIU Building Bhaktapur - Ambika Amatya, District Coordinator, HRRP Bhaktapur Lalitpur Cluster - Nearly 22-23 beneficiaries and their household members from retrofitting category
Facilitator	Shiva Prasad Bhandari, DSE, DLPIU Building Bhaktapur
Report Prepared By:	Ambika Amatya, District Coordinator, HRRP Bhaktapur Lalitpur Cluster

Summary

Orientation to Retrofitting Beneficiaries of Bhaktapur Municipality on Retrofitting Measures

Bhaktapur Municipality was amongst the mostly devastated municipality in Bhaktapur district by Nepal earthquake 2015. There are altogether 161 beneficiaries in retrofitting list however only 43 of them have taken 1st tranche. Reconstruction data of Bhaktapur Municipality-

Total Beneficiaries	7656
PA enrolled	5637
1st tranche	5637
2nd tranche	1855
3rd tranche	1694
Retrofitting	161
Retrofitting- enrolled beneficiary	43
Retrofitting 1 st tranche	43

It was revealed time and again from NRA engineers of Bhaktapur Municipality and from the Retrofitting Task Group Team of DLPIU Building Bhaktapur that none of the retrofitting beneficiaries have applied retrofitting procedures in their houses despite they have taken 1st tranche. It was revealed by the beneficiaries themselves that they have utilized the 1st tranche in conducting minor repair and maintenance of their houses however none of them have applied standard and certified processes of retrofitting measures.

As an important part of Retrofitting Task Group Team of DLPIU Building Bhaktapur, an orientation on retrofitting measures was conducted at meeting hall of Bhaktapur Municipality dated 13th November 2019 from 11 AM -1 PM. Bhaktapur Municipality coordinated with DLPIU Building Bhaktapur office in informing the retrofitting beneficiaries for their compulsory presence in the orientation. Out of 43 retrofitting beneficiaries, nearly 22 of them have attended the orientation.

Summary

The main purpose of conducting orientation was to instill key messages among retrofitting beneficiaries that houses in retrofitting category can be technically retrofitted to make it technically livable again.

A brief and concise presentation about data on retrofitting beneficiaries, various kind of housing typologies in practice and needful retrofitting measures that can be applied were shared with the available beneficiaries by Shiva Kumar Bhandari and Prabesh Adhikari, District Support Engineers of DLPIU Building Bhaktapur. NRA Engineers of Bhaktapur Municipality was also present throughout the orientation along with Mr. Bibek Gautam, M & E Specialist of DLPIU GMALI Bhaktapur and HRRP Bhaktapur Team Member.

Some of the issues discussed during the orientation by beneficiaries are –

- One beneficiary revealed that in a 4 storey wall system house with 14 inch pillar at ground level, some portion of connection were broke between wall & RCC slab. The beneficiary intended to retrofit the house unaware about the correct measures to be applied.
- 2 houses are in retrofitting category however currently the house is owned by sibling, multiple beneficiaries and the house stands on single plot but only beneficiary owns PA agreement card.
- One house is in retrofitting category, however NRA engineers have inspected it time & again during their regular site visit and have suggested the beneficiary to submit application to shift into full damage category.
- Multiple beneficiaries (siblings in relation) having SMC house with 2 storey intends to retrofit the house.
- Beneficiary had BMM house of 4 storey. 1st tranche of retrofitting grant were applied in repair and maintenance works on outer part of wall, however cracks still persists.

Responses to queries of beneficiaries from Shiva Kumar Bhandari, District Support Engineer (DSE)

- From technical point of view, the houses in retrofitting category with upto RCC 4 -5 stories should reduce the stories (upto 2 stories should be chopped off). Technically, the extended stories exposes further threat and risk to the partially damaged house.
- Also, partially damaged house with typology of SMM and BMM having 3-4 stories are often impossible to conduct technically certified retrofitting processes however some correction measures can be done whereby reducing at least upto 2 stories and addition of major bands such as sil, lintel and vertical reinforcement. Retrofitting of SMM and BMM houses incurs huge sum of money. Technically the retrofitting works is not feasible in SMM and BMM houses whose foundation and wall have been affected by earthquake.
- Retrofitting Task Group under DSE and Focal Engineer will inspect the houses of intending beneficiaries in retrofitting list and cross check whether the house is suitable for retrofitting or not and also provide suitable way forward for the beneficiaries.

A short visit was carried out in Ward no 2, Byasi, Bhaktapur Municipality to observe 2 houses of retrofitting beneficiaries and to provide relevant retrofitting measures to be applied in the visited houses as well as to provide advises to the beneficiaries.

Questions/Issues Collected	Who asked the Question?	Response Provided
My BMM house is more than 30 years old with upto 5 storey. I want to retrofit my house as it has partial cracks only. Is it possible to retrofit my house ?	Retrofitting Beneficiary	From technical point of view, partially damaged house with typology of SMM and BMM having 5 stories are often impossible to conduct retrofitting processes as it incurs huge amount of money. Therefore, if beneficiary can bear cost then full demolishing of the quake damaged house and its reconstruction is highly recommended. (District Support Engineer, DLPIU Building, Bhaktapur)

Questions/Issues Collected	Who asked the Question?	Response Provided
My house is a 4 storey wall system house with 14 inch pillar at ground level, however some portion of connection were broke between wall & RCC slab. The beneficiary intended to retrofit the house unaware about the correct measures to be applied.	Beneficiary	Firstly, Retrofitting Task Group under DSE and Focal Engineer will inspect the houses and cross check whether the house is suitable for retrofitting or not and also provide suitable way forward for the beneficiaries. Secondly, at least 1 or 1.5 stories need to be chopped off (reduction in stories number) to reduce further threat during retrofitting process. Thirdly, the beneficiary should be mentally ready to bear the retrofitting cost as government provided tranche amount is only a grant amount given to inspire owners to initiate reconstruction or retrofitting by themselves. (District Support Engineer, DLPIU Building, Bhaktapur)
My house is in retrofitting category however NRA engineers of Bhaktapur Municipality who happened to inspect my house time to time have revealed that my house should go in full reconstruction list. I am totally confused, how my problem can be solved?	Beneficiary	DSE will inspect the houses and cross check whether the house is suitable for retrofitting or not and also provide suitable way forward for the beneficiaries. After the inspection by DSE, if the house is suggested technically to shift into reconstruction list then the beneficiary should request a genuine application letter to be issued from Ward office to concerned Municipality for shifting from Retrofitting category to Reconstruction Category. Once the shifting processes is kicked off, GMALI will coordinate with Building office to facilitate the concerned beneficiaries. (M & E Specialist, DLPIU GMALI, Bhaktapur)

Photographs



Sharing of key highlights of retrofitting measures by engineer of DLPIU Building Bhaktapur in local language



Prabesh Adhikari, DSE, DLPIU Building Bhaktapur is giving presentation on retrofitting measures